



SDEA PART 1

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The first part of the SDEA exam consists of three questions, and you should prepare your responses for each in advance to maximize your score. Part 1 is particularly significant due to its flexibility. This is your prime opportunity to demonstrate that you master a myriad of diverse and sophisticated English expressions. Keep in mind that this is a proficiency test; you are expected to utilize the full range of your language skills to succeed. Which means you can be both formal and informal with no exaggeration, of course.

AVIATION TOPICS

1. Why did you decide to become a pilot ?

(M) Start with a discourse marker - First of all,

(Q) Repeat the question - I decided to become a pilot

(R1) give the reason 1 - because my father was a pilot.

ex: First of all, I decided to become a pilot because my father was a pilot.

2. Why did you decide to become a pilot ?

(M1) + (Q) + (R1) + (M2) + (R2)

ex: In the first place, I decided to become a pilot because my father was a pilot, and second, I like the status of it.

3. Why did you decide to become a pilot?

(M1) + (Q) + (R1) + (M2) + (R2) + (M3) + (R3)

To get started, I decided to become a pilot because my father was a pilot, and also, I like the status of it, not only that but, pilots make a lot of money.



4. Why did you decide to become a pilot?

(M1) + (Q) + (R1) + (M2) + (R2) + (M3) + (R3) + (M4) + (R3)

To begin with, I decided to become a pilot because my father was a pilot, and also, I like the status of it. In addition, pilots make a lot of money, and finally, I think that flying is the most beautiful thing in the world.

5. Why did you decide to become a pilot?

(M1) + (Q) + (R1) + (M2) + (R2) + (M3) + (R3) + (M4) + (R3) + (M5) + (R4)

First and foremost, I decided to become a pilot because my father was a pilot, plus, I like the status of it, besides, pilots make a lot of money, furthermore, I think that flying is the most beautiful thing in the world, and last but not least, I love the idea of living like a bird, even if it just for a couple of hours.

Here are some examples of structures that could be used during the exam, but feel free to create your ones.

Question 1 : What makes a briefing effective ?

To get started, briefing is a moment in which pilots and crew members discuss... blá blá blá ... There are many things that make a briefing effective: The first one is ... blá blá blá ... Because ... blá blá blá ... The second is ... blá blá blá ... Last but not least ... blá blá blá ... Because ... blá blá blá One example of it is ... blá blá blá...

To get started - discourse marker

There are many things - building the structure

First one is - to introduce the first idea

Because - to explain the first idea

The Second is - to introduce the second idea

Last but not least - to introduce the last idea

Because - to explain the last idea

One example - to bring your own experience to the exam.



Question 2: What is the importance of CRM?

To begin with, CRM is the technique to communicate ... blá blá blá... in which pilots and crew members discuss... blá blá blá ... It is really important for many reasons.

First and foremost is ... blá blá blá ... because ... blá blá blá ... Additionally ... blá blá blá ... and Finally ... blá blá blá ... because ... blá blá blá and one thing that happened to me was ... blá blá blá...

To begin with - discourse marker

It is really important for many reasons - building the structure

First and foremost is - to introduce the first idea

Because - to explain the first idea

Additionally - to introduce the second idea

Finally - to introduce the last idea

Because - to explain the last idea

One thing that happened to me was - to bring your own experience to the exam.

Question 3: What can cause an engine failure?

From the get go, whenever we talk about failures we should say that it is caused by a variety of reasons. Here is what comes to my mind first ... blá blá blá ... because ... blá blá blá... Not only that but also ... blá blá blá... because ... blá blá blá... Guess what ? it happened to a friend of mine, he was about to finish the after takeoff check list and then... blá blá blá...

From the get go - discourse marker

A variety of reasons - building the structure

What comes to my mind first - to introduce the first idea

Because - to explain the first idea

Not only that but also - to introduce another idea

Because - to explain this idea

Guess what ? it happened to a friend of mine - to bring your own experience to the exam.



Connectors and discourse markers

1. Addition

Airport - Aircraft vocab

And: I love being a pilot, **and** I also enjoy talking to the controllers.

Also: She's a talented air traffic controller; **also**, she works as a flight attendant.

Plus: I've finished my flight plan; **plus**, I've even done some extra reading.

Furthermore: He's a great flight instructor; **furthermore**, he always takes the initiative.

Moreover: She's an excellent flight attendant leader; **moreover**, she has a vision for a different future in aviation.

In addition: I like reading my logbook; **in addition**, I have a keen interest in en-route charts.

Additionally: I do not enjoy turnaround times; **additionally**, I've started a company focused on reducing it.

Not only... but also: He has **not only** fixed his altimeter **but also** the brakes.

Besides: I saw fire in the aft cargo hold; **besides**, there is smoke coming out of it.

2. Contrast

Airport - Aircraft vocab

But: I was looking carefully, **but** the conveyor belt did bring my luggage.

Yet: It was working fine, **yet** I decided to shut the engine down.

However: The engine was ok; **however**, the fan blades were destroyed.

On the other hand: I retracted the flaps; **on the other hand**, my co-pilots forgot to check the fuel flow.

Conversely: Some pilots use to check all the gauges; **conversely**, others prefer to ignore it.

Nevertheless: It was close to the fuel truck; **nevertheless**, the co-pilot was near the fuselage.

Although: **Although** I'm scared of landing gear failures, I try not to think about it.



Even though: **Even though** the nose gear was twisted, he could land the plane safely.

While: **While** the propeller was working just fine, the radar screen went blank.

Whereas: I was looking for traffic, **whereas** my co-pilot was running the checklist.

3. Cause and Effect

Airport - Aircraft vocab

So: I was at the runway threshold, so I decided to take off immediately.

Because: The tailplane, also known as horizontal stabilizer, hit the terminal gate **because** the pilots were spaced out.

Since: Since the thermostats stopped working, we should inform the tower.

Therefore: We didn't check the tires; therefore, they were flat when we started taxiing.

Consequently: Our undercarriage collapsed; **consequently**, we had to request a tug.

As a result: The runway was slippery; **as a result**, we hit an unknown object, a FOD, during the taxi back.

Hence: He had a problem with his undercarriage, **hence** he had to take the warning light seriously.

Thus: There was smoke coming out of the wheel well, **thus** she decided to deliver a distress call.

Due to: My windscreen got shattered **due to** a bird strike.

Owing to: The flight was delayed owing to a cracked windshield.

4. Emphasis

Navigation vocab

Indeed: The alternative route is good; **indeed**, it's one of the best I've seen.

In fact: Due to bad weather we had to deviate; **in fact**, it was too bad that we had to divert to another airport.

Especially: Some aircraft have to be grounded, **especially** when they undergo heavy maintenance.



Particularly: Some maneuvers are not allowed at our airport, **particularly** low pass procedures.

Clearly: **Clearly**, there's been a misunderstanding between the pilot and the controller.

Obviously: **Obviously**, at that speed during the approach the pilot will overrun the runway.

Undoubtedly: **Undoubtedly**, this bad weather will prevent us from landing at the destination.

Importantly: **Importantly**, always remember to proceed straight to the destination.

5. Clarification

Navigation vocab

I mean: I like to taxi straight to the RWY, **I mean**, I try to avoid pushbacks at all costs.

In other words: The weather is inclement along this route ; **in other words**, it's unpredictable and severe.

That is: We can not continue the flight on this heading, **that is**, the controller must redirect us.

Namely: There is just one place for engine check, **namely**, the run up area.

To put it another way: There was too much traffic; **to put it another way**, the controller had to provide some spacing .

To clarify: **To clarify**, I was referring to the truck to push us back.

6. Illustration

Navigation vocab / Security

For example: Turnaround time is crucial to aviation; **for example**, most delays are caused by turnaround time.

For instance: I have to slow down sometimes; **for instance**, on final we have to maintain the speed within a certain limit.

Such as: Many problems may occur during flights, such as aggressive passengers, angry people or armed folks.

Like: Problems might happen during flights **like** stolen bags.



Namely: There were dangerous situations on board, namely, bombs, dangerous goods and hazmat.

Specifically: A man hit a passenger on board, specifically the stewardess.

7. Sequence

Security and Flight operations vocab

First: First, they restrained the passenger.

Next: Next, they released him.

Then: Then, a sniffer dog enters the cabin.

Lastly: Lastly, a terrorist was arrested.

Finally: Finally, a suspicious woman and an unruly passenger were misbehaving.

After that: After that a violent passenger showed his weapon to everyone.

Subsequently: He completed his turn; subsequently, he had to carry out the check list.

Meanwhile: The screens stopped working ; meanwhile, they had to copy the clearances by radio calls.

Simultaneously: The jetway was simultaneously detached from the plane.

Thereafter: They had an engine failure, thereafter they delivered a distress signal.

8. Conclusion

Flight operations vocab

In conclusion: In conclusion, the engine was still running.

To sum up: To sum up, we could not extend the flaps

In summary: In summary, a false altimeter reading was responsible for the crash.

All in all: All in all, it was a memorable trip.

Overall: Overall, baking left was not a good idea at that point.

To conclude: To conclude, further maintenance is needed to fix the jammed landing gear.

In short: In short, practice makes perfect.



9. Opinion

In my opinion: In my opinion, the jetbridge was detached.

I believe: I believe distress signals should be followed with caution.

I think: I think the flaps are extended.

Personally: Personally, I prefer manual control over autopilot.

It seems to me: It seems to me that the aircraft is pitching up right now.

10. Time

Now: Now, there is radio interference going on.

Today: Today, the landing gear of an aircraft did not retract.

Recently: Recently, there have been a lot of engine failures.

Previously: Previously, the pilot had switched off the landing lights.

Soon: The departure procedure will start soon.

Sooner than Later: Due to bad weather the aircraft will ask for a deviation sooner than later.

Until: The marshaller will wait until the plane is parked.

Whenever: The pilot will contact Center Control whenever he is levelled.

As long as: The vehicle can stay on the runway as long as necessary.

By the time: By the time we arrived, the plane had already departed.

11. Condition

Zero conditional: if I study too much, I get tired.

First conditional: if it rains, the takeoff will be canceled.

Second conditional: if I had an airplane, I would get out of here right now.

Third conditional: if I had trained more, I would have passed my check ride.

Unless: I won't land unless my undercarriage is totally extended.

Provided that: You can join the pattern work provided that you ask the ATCO.

In case: File an IFR flight plan in case you need it.

As long as: As long as you're cleared, you can embark in a plane.

Supposing: Supposing we miss the flight, what's our backup plan?

On condition that: You can depart on condition that you fill out the weight and balance sheet.



12. Agreement

Of course: Are you always allowed to ask for a diversion if weather deteriorates at the destination airport? Of course!

Definitely: Are you coming to the final destination airport? – **Definitely!**

Surely: This picture was **surely** taken during a sunny day.

Indeed: The was **indeed** grounded due to the extent of the damage.

Naturally: The airplane sales were **naturally** successful from the get go.

By all means: Can I use your radar? – **By all means.**

13. Disagreement

However: I initially wanted to become a doctor, however my passion for aviation was already deeply established in my heart.

The contrary: Flying is not expensive; **on the contrary**, it's quite affordable.

In contrast: Summer is hot; in contrast, winter is cold and snowy.

Nonetheless: It was raining; nonetheless, the pilot decided to fly.

14. Limitation

But: I wanted to abort the takeoff, **but** it was too late.

Yet: I tried my best, **yet** I couldn't complete the approach.

Although: **Although** she was tired, she continued running the check list.

Even though: **Even though** he had little experience, he managed to do a great job on the traffic pattern.

However: I love the concept; however, the execution could be better.

15. Possibility

Maybe: **Maybe** I'll join the left downwind earlier.

Perhaps: **Perhaps** we can find a solution together.

Possibly: It's possibly the best option we have.

Potentially: This is a **potentially** groundbreaking discovery.

Could: We **could** divert to a different airport tonight.

Might: She **might** contact the ATC in a couple of minutes.



'Aviation topics - PART 1

Official instruction (ANAC)

Part One: "Aviation Topics". In this part, you have to answer questions related to aviation. You should take approximately one to two minutes to answer each question and I will tell you when to stop if necessary.

1. What can airline companies do in order to promote flight safety?

Well, as far as I am concerned, airline companies can promote flight safety, in many different ways, firstly via air safety reports, because other pilots could form preview errors. Additionally, investing in resources and development of C.R.M could reduce power distance. Finally, companies can also promote flight safety by mitigating the risks in terms of crew and corporate fatigue by augmenting the number of crew members.

2. What is the importance of C.R.M.?

In my view, C.R.M. is crucial for flight safety, in various ways. In the first place, I believe that it is extremely important because it could prevent not only incidents but also air disasters. In the second place, C.R.M. has several fronts such as leadership development, teamwork, situational awareness and also power distance reduction. In the last place, I could also say that CRM is a powerful tool to develop a safety culture in the organisation in which everybody has individual responsibilities and are aware of his/her importance.

3. Why is it important for pilots to perform regular health checks? CMA.

Well, as a matter of fact, I believe that regular health checks are essential for pilots because of many reasons. But the most important one is that they could identify health problems or even mental disorders in advance, which could prevent accidents. Actually, nowadays pilots have been working too much and as a result of this high workload, they are consequently subject to several sicknesses mainly related to spine

problems, bloodstream alterations and also skin cancer due to the direct exposure to sunlight.

4. Tell me about your background as a pilot/ aviation carrier/ aviation history.

Well, you know, I started my aviation career in 1999 as a cadet at AFA. After graduation I went to Natal to initiate my flight training as a fighter. A couple of years later I was transferred back to AFA where I became an instructor in both T-25 and T27. Right after that I was invited to integrate the Smoke Squadron team and started my training period in 2012. During four years I delivered aerobatic presentations around the world, which was amazing. Nonetheless I had an accident at the end of the fourth year, I had an engine fire and had to bail out. After recovery, I retired from the Brazilian Air Force and joined United Airlines as an Airbus captain and I have been there since 2020 up to today.

5. Why did you decide to become a pilot?

I decided to become a pilot for various reasons, the first one is that I have always loved aviation since my childhood. At that time, my family used to take me to an airport close by and I was fascinated by seeing the aircraft landing and taking off. The second reason is due to stability. You know, stability is really important nowadays. It is also really good when you know that you are not going to be fired for no reason. Last but not least, it is because of the use of uniforms. Since a very young age I have seen war movies with fighter pilots using those uniforms, and one day, during a movie, I looked at my father and told him _Dad, one day you are going to see me wearing those uniforms, and he replied _ Go for it kido! And I actually did.

6. What are the difficulties of being a pilot?

There are many challenges of becoming a pilot however, as far as I am concerned, the most significant ones are: First, staying away from my family often and missing out on important dates such as birthdays and Christmas. Secondly, it is a demanding and exhausting job that can be very stressful sometimes, and finally, I think that getting the first job as a commercial pilot is a work cut out due to the lack of experience at the beginning of a pilots career.

7. When do pilots need to perform an emergency landing?

To the best of my knowledge, there are several situations in which it may require an emergency landing to be performed. They are usually directly related to the times when the safety of the flight is compromised. Some of them might include fire onboard, engine fire, engine failure, depressurization and pilot incapacitation. I actually had to perform an emergency landing on one specific occasion after experiencing an engine failure. Nevertheless, all the procedures prior to performing these emergency procedures must be followed according to the checklist and of course, efficient C.R.M practice in the cockpit and communication amongst crew members are also crucial when pilots are facing critical moments.

8. What is your opinion about drones and what are the risks for aviation?

Well, from the get go, I think that drones are fantastic flying machines and they are really fun to play with. They have been used for a variety of purposes including photography, cinema, security and of course, aviation. As a matter of fact, military drones could prevent pilots from engaging in risky missions such as having to fly far into dangerous air spaces in war zones. However, drones can be dangerous for commercial and private aircraft in many different ways. One of them could occur during approach and takeoff phases of flight, the risks include striking the aircraft or being ingested by the engines. Another one is the possibility of failures. When drones fail, they might lose signal and fall into houses, cars, streets and so on. I believe that all drones must be legally registered so they can be easily tracked. This way we can hold people accountable for the damage they might cause.

9. What is the difference between V1 and V2?

The difference between V1 and V2 is that V1 is the decision speed; Therefore, at V1 pilots must decide whether to continue or reject the takeoff in case of emergencies such as: an engine failure, engine fire, engine high vibration or a FOD ingestion for example. Conversely, V2 is the safety speed for completion of the takeoff which includes the designated screen height at the end of the runway or clearway and safe obstacle

clearance. Just to conclude, V2 is the best one engine climbing speed in case of an engine failure.

10. Tell me about your current situation as a pilot.

I am currently working as a flight instructor at São Paulo Flight School. I perform twenty-hour-per-week flights and I take students for flight instruction in a Cessna 172/182 which is an American low-wing, single-engine, conventional-tail aircraft made by Cessna Aircraft Company. Moreover, I am taking the ICAO test because I need it because I want to work as a commercial pilot in Brazil. I am particularly looking forward to working at United airlines in the United States or in China.

11. How did you become interested in flying?

I became interested in flying for a couple of reasons. One of them is that I used to live near an airport and I loved to see the airplanes movement at that airport. In fact, my grandfather used to park the car next to the runway so I could watch the airport traffic almost everyday. In addition to that, I have always collected a lot of aviation magazines and I still do.

12. What aircraft do you dream of flying in the future?

Actually, I have always dreamt of flying the Concorde but unfortunately, it is no longer possible as this aircraft has retired from service. In terms of the future, I would love to fly a Boeing 747-8, it is a fantastic aircraft with redesigned wings, new engines, and improved efficiency. The 747-8 is not only the largest 747 version but also the largest commercial aircraft built in the United States. Furthermore, it is known for being the longest passenger aircraft in the world.

13. What would you do in the case of an engine failure after takeoff?

First of all, I would make a plan of action. For takeoffs, for instance, I would make sure I know the runway length and calculate the acceleration and stopping distance. In addition to that, I would also ensure I know where I will fly to if I can't make it back to the departure airport. If I had a multi-engine aeroplane, I would know the exact single-engine climb speed (V2), which would then become my target airspeed if an engine fails.

Moreover, I would make sure to review my plan before acting. Smart decision making in the case of an unexpected event can be a critical factor and save lives.

Just to conclude, I think that it is extremely important to practice in flight simulators. You can never practice too much. Prepare for every possibility so you can respond quickly when necessary.

14. What do pilots do after liftoff?

After liftoff firstly, pilots should command gear up and retract the flaps. Then, they should try to reach the flight level and maintain the heading as filed. Once reaching cruise flight pilots must perform a series of checklists and about 15 minutes before starting the descent to the final destination they should prepare the cockpit and set up the configuration of the aircraft to land safely at their arrival airport.

15. How do you think the Airbus A380 can interfere with airport operations?

First of all, the Airbus A380 is one of the largest wide-body aircraft that operates in commercial aviation nowadays; therefore, specific procedures and adaptations to airport operations will be required in order to accommodate such aircraft. For instance, this airplane creates wake turbulence which can be very dangerous for other aircraft taking off or landing before or after it. However, It is expected from the pilots to adjust their flight path to avoid wake turbulence.

16. How has aviation changed/ improved/ developed in the last 10 years?

From where I see, aviation has definitely changed in the last 10 years. First, in terms of avionics, I believe that nowadays there is more information available for pilots in the cockpit. In addition, regarding safety, I also believe that more security procedures have been implemented which I think is a positive change. Finally, in my opinion, aviation has also grown in the last 10 years as air transportation became more accessible.

17. How important is it for pilots to perform regular health checks?

As a matter of fact, it is very important for pilots to perform regular health checks. One of the reasons is that pilots are subject to great stress and workload which can result in tiredness and fatigue. Moreover, regular health checks can detect future or hidden sickness that may affect the pilot's health in the future.

18. In your opinion, will pilots be replaced by automated systems in the future? Do you think that in the future there will be only one pilot in the cockpit?

In my opinion, technology is increasing by the minute and I think that there will be an aircraft being flown by computers. Nevertheless, in commercial aviation, I do not think that will be the case. Firstly because I don't think passengers will feel comfortable knowing that there are no pilots in the flight deck or maybe only one pilot managing the computer that is flying the plane. So, I think that computers will fly the aircraft but the pilots will always be needed in the cockpit to manage the systems and take over if there is a computer failure or malfunction.

19. Why is it important for pilots to know about dangerous goods on board?

dangerous good, cargo hold,

It is crucial that pilots have detailed information about dangerous goods onboard. If there are flammable liquids for example and they catch fire the pilots need to inform the firefighters and report the specific location of the dangerous goods so the ground could provide assistance. Also, some dangerous good requires specific papers work and permits, so the pilots should always make sure they know what they are carrying and what are the risks.

20. What's the importance of C.R.M.?

Well, from my standpoint, Corporate Resource Management helps to promote teamwork and communication during aircraft operation and therefore assures flight safety. In other words, the concepts of CRM are to reduce error, avoid stress consequently, increase efficiency. The idea is that

the flight crew should work together much like a well-oiled machine if the principles of CRM are respected.

21. What is the best/ worst airport you have ever operated in?

we had not we have problem, fire

As far as I remember, the best airport I have ever operated in is the Frankfurt airport.

Firstly, this airport is not only one of the biggest and busiest airports in the world but also one of the most well connected in Germany. Frankfurt Airport has 2 train stations that facilitate passenger mobility tremendously. In terms of runways, taxiways and Apron areas it is huge and it can accommodate a very large number of aircraft operating simultaneously.

22. What is the difference between a good briefing and a bad briefing?

In my opinion, a good briefing involves a good amount of detailed information concerning the flight such as aircraft condition, weather conditions in route, procedures for abnormal situations and relevant information about passengers and dangerous goods onboard. In addition to that, a good briefing gives the opportunity for crewmembers to clarify any doubts they may have in regards to the flight. On the other hand, a bad briefing lacks information and does not provide relevant instructions to crew members.

23. In your opinion, how do you think aviation will be like in the future?

From my standpoint, in the future, there will be a lot of improvements especially in terms of flight safety. In addition, in terms of avionics, I believe there will be more computer systems that will help the pilots to manage the systems of the aircraft. Moreover, I think that air travel will be more accessible for a larger number of the population and perhaps the tickets will be a lot cheaper.

24. How do you think international airports will be like in the future in terms of infrastructure?

Well, in terms of airport infrastructure, I think that in the future, firstly, most airports will be able to perform international flights. Secondly, the airports will have more terminal buildings and more facilities for passenger comfort and mobility. And finally, in terms of operations, there will be parallel landings and takeoffs.

25. How do you think cockpits will be like in the future?

To begin with, I believe that in the future the cockpits will be even more advanced in terms of technology. First, I think that there will be more screens and fewer buttons. Also, I think the pilots will only manage the systems and the computers will fly the aircraft. And finally, I think that the cockpits will have more reliable backup systems and it will be more comfortable for the pilots.

26. What was the most technological airport you have ever operated in?

Private, another places for pilots - other places - the pilots - pilots

The most technological airport that I have operated is Brasilia airport because first, the airport has two very long runways and many gates. In addition, the airport is equipped with an ILS system in the 4 thresholds which helps the pilots to perform precision landings. Finally, In terms of passengers, there are many facilities in the terminal buildings Such as restaurants and many shops.

27. What do pilots do when they finish their flights?

Well after parking the aircraft at the jetway, the pilots normally perform a parking checklist that includes: fuel pumps and APU bleeds and of course, make sure that the start selector is in the off position. In addition to that, pilots turn off the beacon lights and after that, the pilots perform a briefing with maintenance in order to discuss the aircraft status.

28. How do you like to prepare yourself for a flight?

Well, the way I like to prepare myself for a flight is with as much anticipation as possible. First, I do my best to keep myself fit by practising sports, sleeping well and maintaining a healthy diet. Especially prior to the

flight, I avoid alcohol and try to sleep at least 8 hours so I feel fresh for the flight.

Regarding the flight – I try to get as much information as possible such as checking all the paperwork on board so the bureaucracy is in accordance with the regulations. Obviously checking the charts, the weather and checking if the aircraft is fit for the flight. I like performing a walk around and talking to the crew members as well, in general, just making sure I am on top of everything concerning the flight.

29. In your opinion, do you think that the Airbus A380 will take over the market from the B 737 as a commercial aircraft?

I don't think so. The reasons are: Firstly, the Airbus A380 is a huge aircraft and therefore it demands specific requirements in terms of jetways, runways and of course air traffic separation due to wake turbulence. In addition, not all airports are equipped to accommodate this aeroplane. Moreover, the Boeing 737 is very suitable for commercial aviation because it can perform short to medium range flights across the country. That's why I don't think that the A380 will take over the market.

30. Tell me about the first aircraft you have flown.

The first aircraft I have flown was a Paulistinha. It is a single-engine, a small plane used for flight instruction. In fact, I believe most pilots learn their fundamental flying skills piloting this aircraft. It is extremely light and the controls are very sensitive. It has fixed landing gear and it flies using very simple avionics.